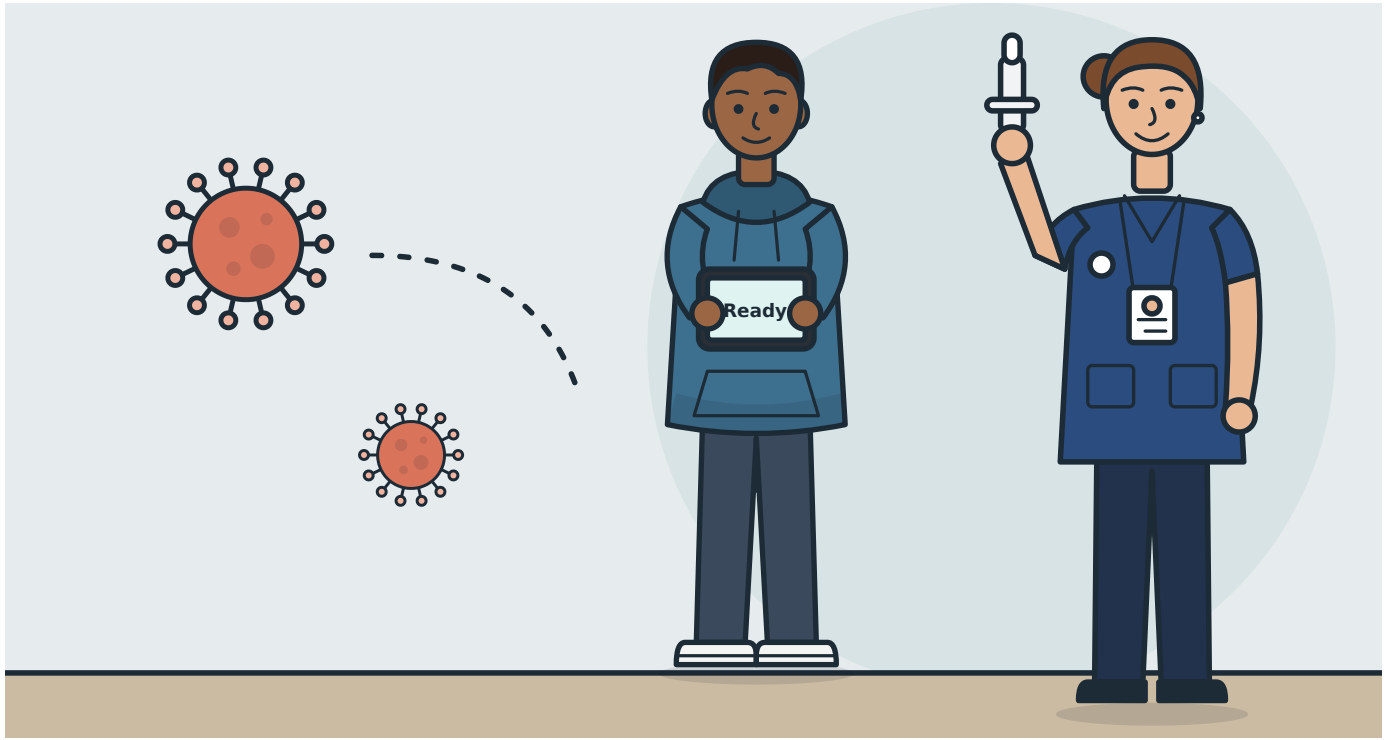




Sam and the **Flu Spray**

A guide about the nasal flu vaccine, for young people who understand a lot and sometimes find talking hard.

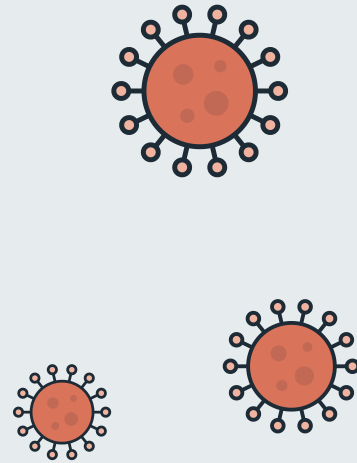
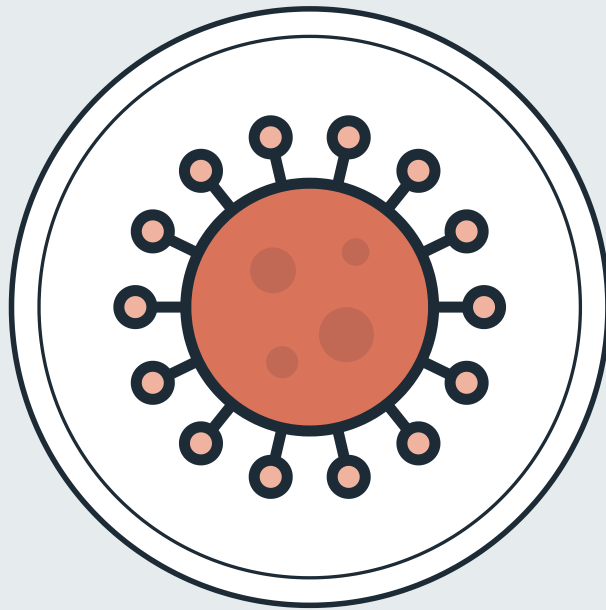


This is me

My name is Sam. I go to school every day.

I understand a lot. Talking can be hard for me, so I use my tablet and my cards to show people what I mean.

People can wait for my answer. I'll get there.



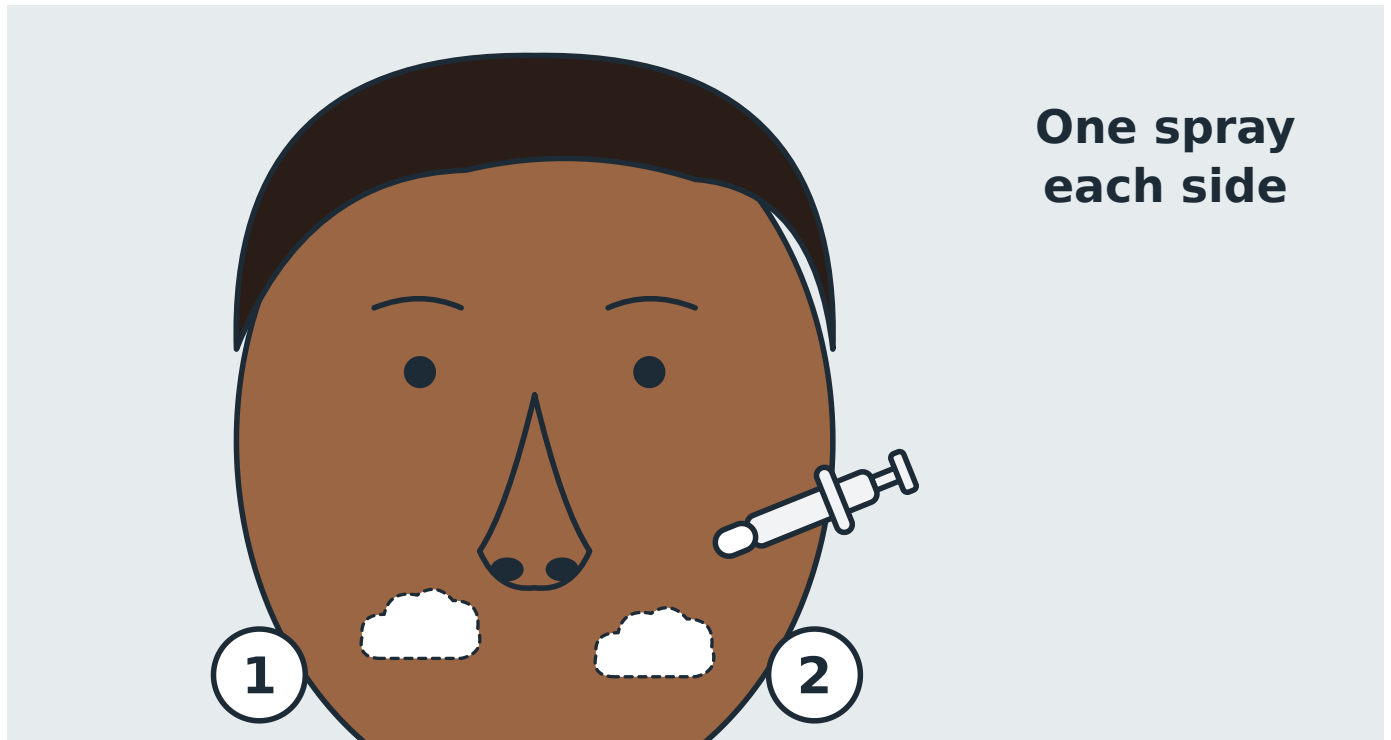
Flu virus, seen through a microscope

What is flu?

Flu is caused by a virus. A virus is far too small to see.

Flu can give you a high temperature, aches, a sore throat and make you very tired. Most people my age get better in about a week.

For some people, like my Nan and my baby cousin Ava, flu can be much more serious.



What is the flu spray?

Every year, schools offer a flu vaccine. For most young people it's a nasal spray.

That means a quick spray inside my nose. **One spray in each nostril.** It isn't a needle. It takes a few seconds.



Before the day

A letter comes home. My parent or carer fills in a form to say yes.

I can use my cards to tell staff how I'm feeling about it. It's OK to feel worried. Lots of people do.



Waiting my turn

On the day, I wait my turn. I might wait with my class or with a member of staff I know.

I can bring something that helps me feel calm, like my headphones.

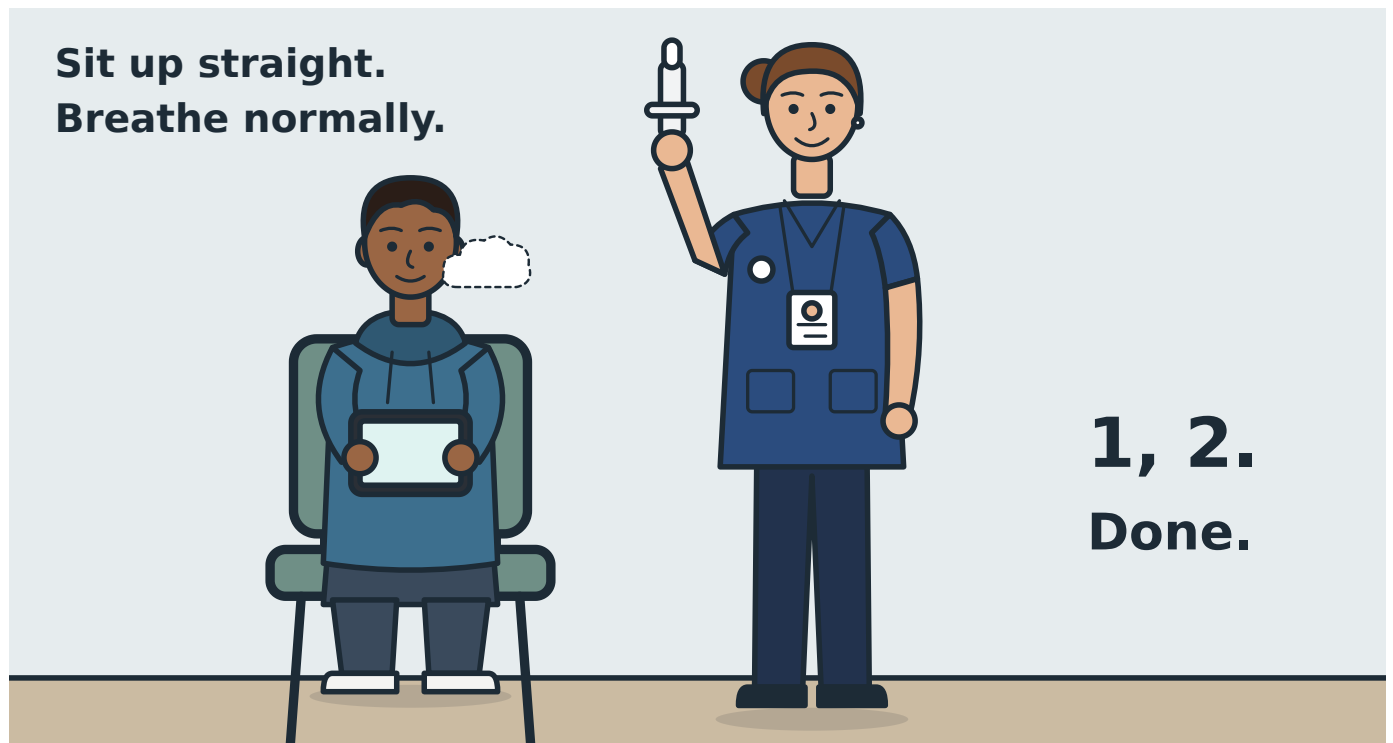


Meeting Nurse Lou

Nurse Lou works with the school immunisation team. She tells me what she's going to do before she does it.

I can show her my **Ready** card or my **Wait please** card.

"I've done 200 noses today," said Nurse Lou. "Yours is my favourite." I typed: "Only because it's the last one?" She laughed.

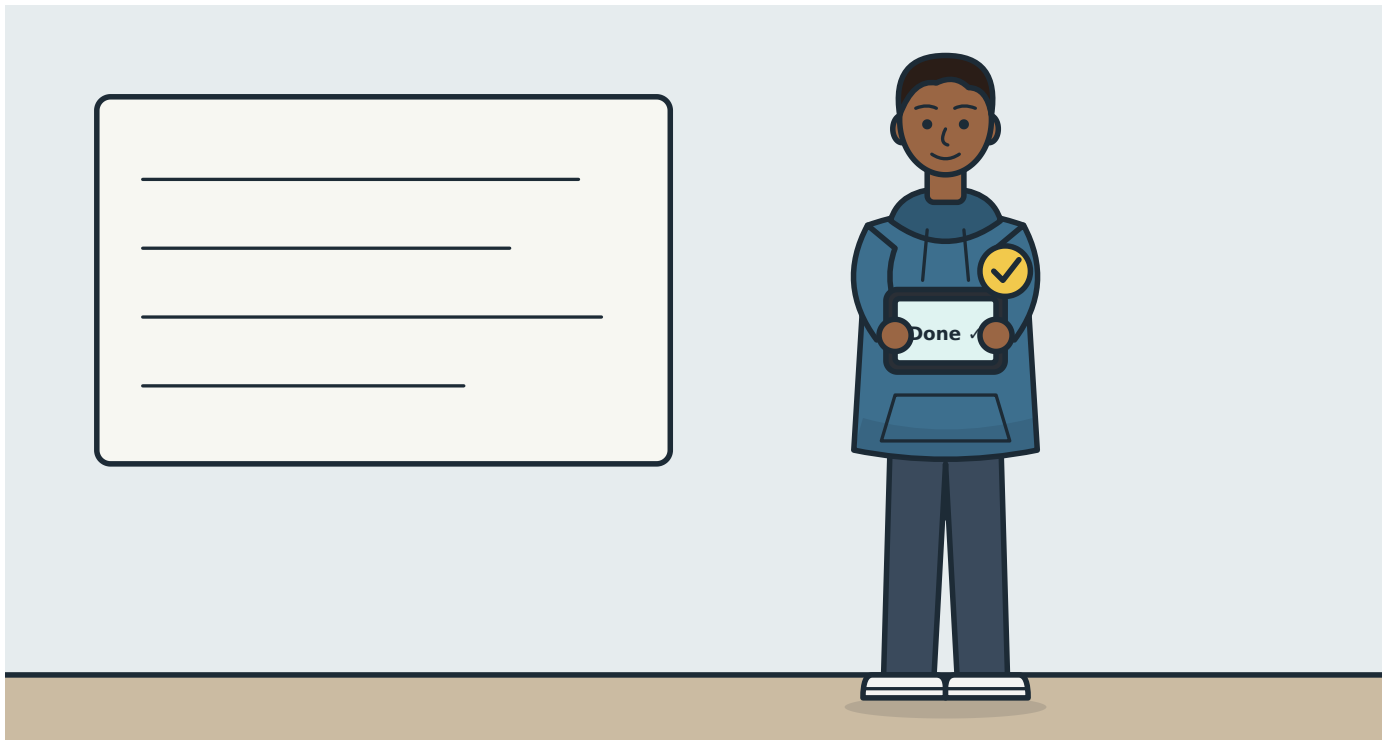


The spray

I sit up straight on the chair. I breathe normally. I don't need to sniff.

Spray one. Spray two. It can feel cold or tickly. If I sneeze, that's OK.

That's it. Done.



Afterwards

My nose might be runny or blocked for a day or two. I might feel a bit tired. That's normal and it soon passes.

Then I go back to class.



Why it matters

Having the flu spray makes me less likely to catch flu. It also makes me less likely to pass it on.

That helps protect Nan, baby Ava and my friends.

Nan says she'll bake a cake to celebrate. Nan will bake a cake for anything.

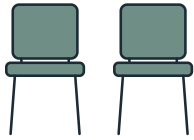
A few seconds for me. A healthier winter for everyone I care about.

Being brave doesn't mean not feeling worried. It means doing it anyway, with the right support.

My flu spray schedule

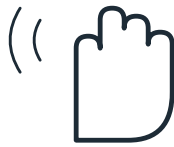
Go through it together before the day. Point to each step as it happens.

1



Wait my turn

2



**Say hello to
the nurse**

3



**Sit up
straight**

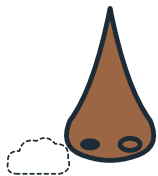
4



in and out

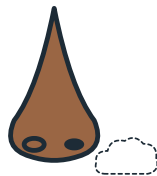
**Breathe
normally**

5



**Spray one
side**

6



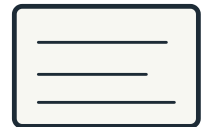
**Spray the
other side**

7



All done

8



Back to class

Some young people have the flu vaccine as an injection instead. That's OK too. It protects in the same way.

My communication cards

Print and cut out. Point to a card to tell staff what you need.

 Ready	 Wait please	 I need a break	 I'm worried
 Yes	 No	 All done	 Help

How I feel right now



1

Calm



2

OK



3

Unsure



4

Worried



5

Very worried

About me, for the nurse

Fill this in together and give it to the immunisation team on the day.

My name is

The best way to communicate with me is

Things that help me stay calm

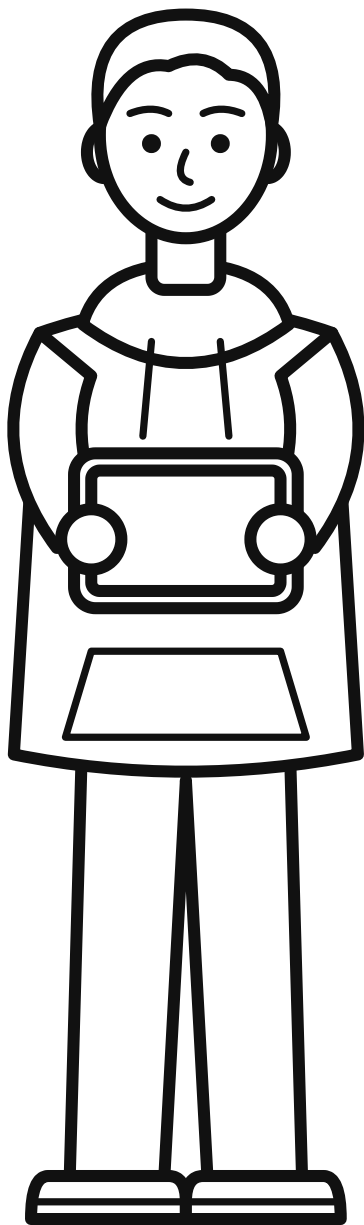
Please don't

After the spray, I'd like

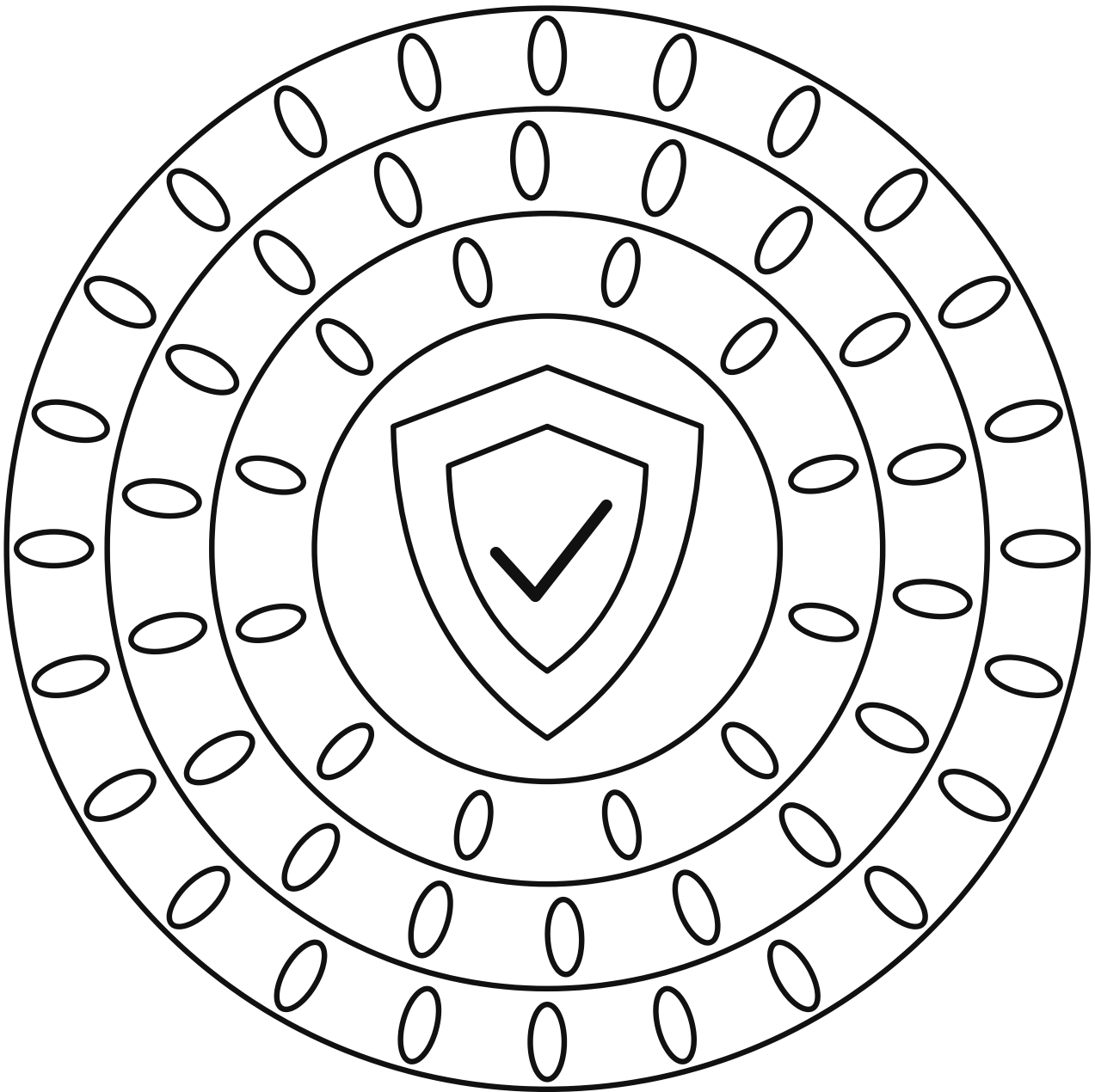
Colouring pages

Four pages to colour. Take your time.

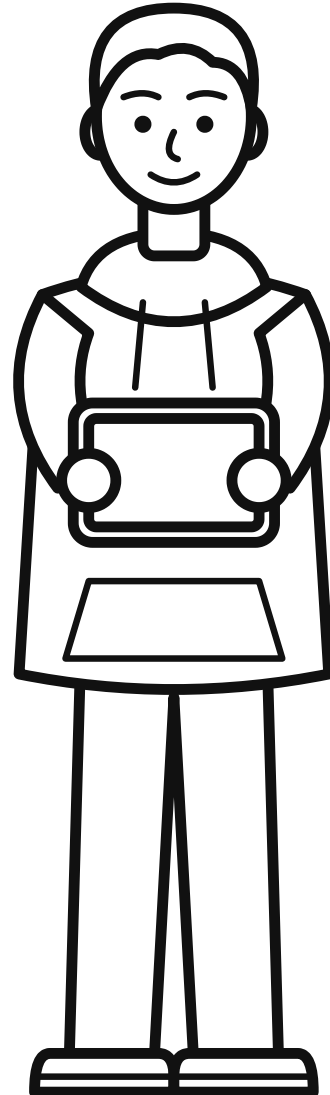
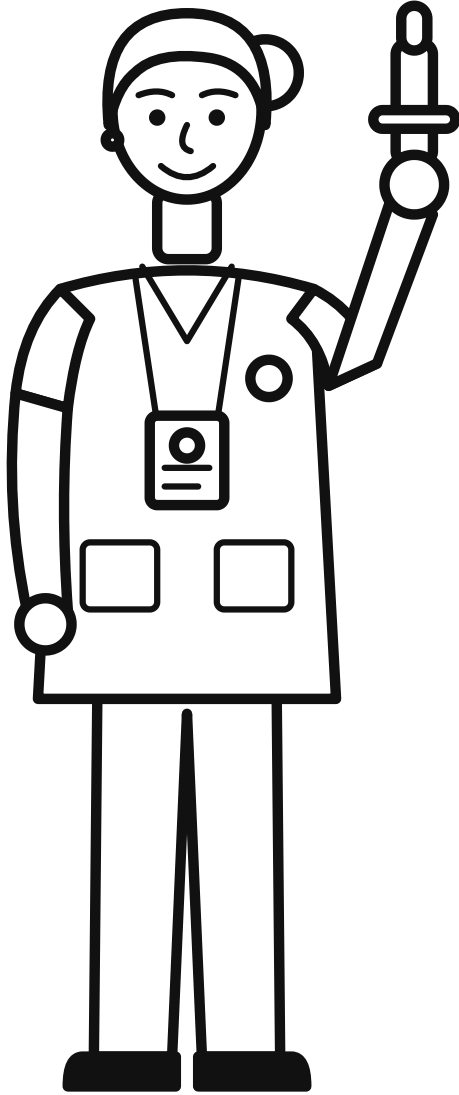
Sam



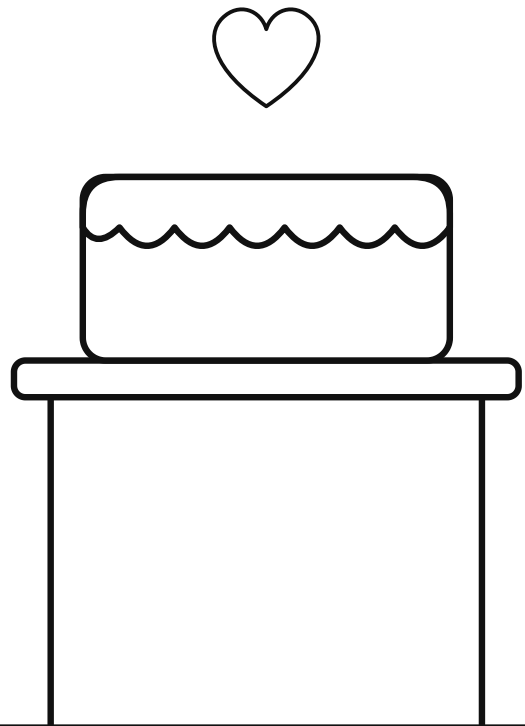
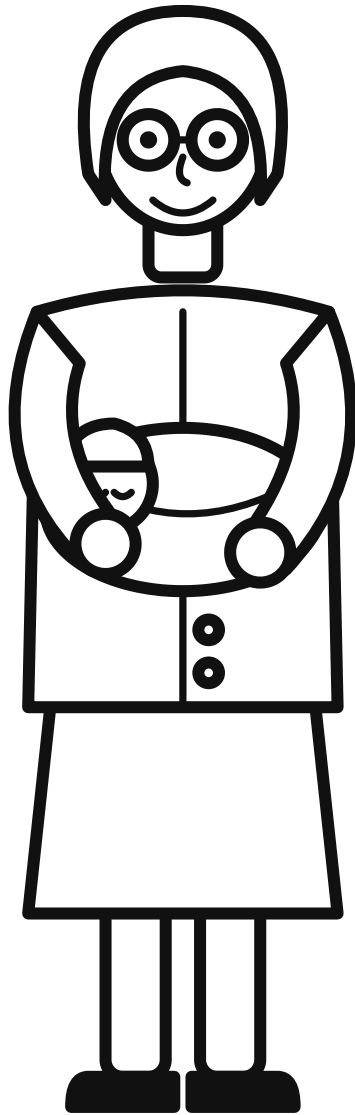
Protected



Nurse Lou and Sam



Nan and baby Ava



For parents, carers and staff

- The children's flu vaccine is usually a nasal spray: one spray into each nostril. It's quick and doesn't hurt. The young person doesn't need to sniff.
- Afterwards some young people get a runny or blocked nose, a headache, tiredness or a smaller appetite for a short time.
- Some are offered an injection instead, for example if the nasal spray isn't suitable for them.
- Vaccination lowers the chance of catching flu and helps stop it spreading to babies, older people and people with long-term conditions. It doesn't guarantee someone won't catch flu.
- Give processing time. Offer the communication cards and the feelings scale before, during and after. Accept a card as a full answer.
- Share the "About me" page with the immunisation team. Ask if a quieter space or a first or last slot is possible.
- Questions? Ask the school immunisation team, your GP practice or a pharmacist.